

A GUIDE FOR PEOPLE LEADERS

CLAUDE COWORK FOR PEOPLE TEAMS

The desktop AI that does the work while you go and live your life. Where most People teams will get their first real operating leverage from agents.

The three layers of Claude.

Three products. Distinct jobs. Cowork is the middle layer — agentic capability for people who don't want a terminal.

01

CLAUDE.AI (CHAT & PROJECTS)

Ask. Think. Draft.

Conversation-focused. You prompt, Claude responds. You stay in the loop on every step.

EVERYONE

02

COWORK (DESKTOP)

Delegate. Walk away. Come back.

Outcome-focused. Multi-step work, scheduled tasks, connectors. You step away — come back to finished work.

PEOPLE OPS

03

CLAUDE CODE (CLI)

Build systems. For the technical.

Terminal. n8n + MCP. Where you build the infrastructure other things run on.

AI CHAMPION

WHAT COWORK ACTUALLY IS

*Regular Claude is your **thinking** partner.
Cowork is the assistant who actually **does the work** while you
go and live your life.*

An agentic AI app that runs on your desktop, where your files live. You give it an outcome. It plans the steps, uses connectors to pull context, executes across multiple files and tools, and returns a finished deliverable.

Two different jobs. Two different tools.

CLAUDE.AI · CHAT & PROJECTS

Where you think.

- Conversation-focused
- You prompt, Claude responds
- Q&A, drafts, thinking
- Context lives in the chat
- You stay in the loop on every step

| *"Help me draft this."*

COWORK · DESKTOP

Where work gets done.

- Outcome-focused
- You describe the result you want
- Multi-step work across files
- Context lives in your file system & connectors
- You step away & come back to finished work

| *"I've read the twelve files, written the report, saved it to Notion."*

WHY IT MATTERS

Agentic AI just walked out of the terminal and onto your desk.

BEFORE COWORK

Agentic AI lived in a developer's terminal. Brilliant if you're comfortable with npm, Docker and MCP JSON files.



WITH COWORK

Your Head of People Ops can delegate multi-step work to an AI without an engineer building anything.

ALREADY IN THE WILD

20h

a week saved on triage at Remote IT Ops.

1x

competitive agent run every day by the Braintrust VP of Marketing.

IT

Buddy running for the whole Clay team, no developer in the loop.

These are not developer stories. They are operations stories.

Four capabilities that make Cowork work.

The agentic architecture from Claude Code is under the hood — you never see it.

01



Projects · for recurring work

A persistent workspace with its own files, connectors, instructions and memory. Set up once. Stop re-explaining your setup.

02



Scheduled tasks

Mondays at 8am. Weekdays. First of the month. A full agentic run that notifies you when done. Your digest writes itself.

03



Computer Use

When nothing else reaches what's needed: logs into the HRIS via your browser, pulls the report, saves the file, keeps going.

04



Dispatch · phone → desktop

The Weekly People Ops Digest.

Every Monday at 7am, before your first meeting.

SOURCES READ

- Notion · Team Directory
- Notion · Leave Tracker
- Notion · Hiring Pipeline
- Slack · #people (last 7 days)
- Gmail · People & exec senders



COWORK

Mon · 7am
Scheduled task



OUTPUT, BY 7:15AM

- 01 What you need to know · 3 bullets
- 02 New starters this week
- 03 People out · by day
- 04 Hiring status
- 05 Open threads · red flags

The digest is waiting before you open your laptop. Monday morning is spent acting on signal, not pulling data.

The Offboarding Pack.

A leaver triggers Cowork to assemble the entire pack while you focus on the human conversation.

TRIGGER

Last day
Friday.

Name · date ·
manager

→ COWORK
ORCHESTRATES

01

Source intel

Read Notion home, last 90 days of 1:1s,
owned project pages.

02

Handover doc

Projects, ownership, decisions,
relationships, doc gaps.

03

Access checklist

Slack channels, tools, equipment —
personalised.

04

Exit interview prep

Themes from 1:1s, known concerns, what to
ask.

05

Final-day Slack draft

Warm, professional, <150 words, in your
tone.

06

Saved & ready to review

Single Notion page in HR archive ·
"Offboarding Pack".

Employee Survey Synthesis.

Slow, careful, multi-source work — the kind that used to wait two weeks for a clear Thursday.

FOLDER · Q1-2026/

- engagement-scores.csv
- verbatim-comments.csv
- focus-group-1.docx
- focus-group-2.docx
- exit-interview-themes.docx

~40 minutes. While you run other things.

THREE OUTPUTS

O1

Exec summary

One page. What moved, what didn't, what matters.

O2

Themed analysis

O3

Discussion prompts

Ten questions to open the exec conversation about the results.

THE GUARDRAIL

Quotes verbatim, anonymised, attributed to source file only. No invented quotes. If a theme is weak on evidence, it says so.

The Vendor Review Pack.

Cowork reads all the paperwork. You think about the decision instead of chasing the evidence.

READS

- PDF Master Services Agreement
- PDF Data Processing Addendum
- PDF SOC 2 Type II report
- PDF Pricing proposal
- DOCX Security questionnaire
- WEB Competitor pricing & reviews · last 6 months

PRODUCES

- 01 Doc summaries · risk flags
- 02 Competitor scan
- 03 Internal overlap check
- 04 Decision memo · <2 pages
- 05 Questions for legal · questions for vendor

Saved to "HR Tech Evaluations" in Notion. Ready when you sit down.

Six habits that separate the teams who get value from the teams who give up.

01

Describe the outcome, not the steps.

If you can't describe the finished deliverable, Cowork can't produce it.

02

Give it everything up front.

03

Build a Project the moment it repeats.

If you write the same setup twice, stop. Move it to a Project. Next time it's one sentence.

04

Check the first three runs. Trust after that.

You're teaching Cowork your standard. After three good runs, move to spot-checks.

05

Use Dispatch for thought capture.

Start the task in the moment the idea lands, instead of storing it for later.

06

Build a team prompt library.

Five minutes saving a good prompt pays back every time someone else needs the same thing.

BEFORE YOU ROLL IT OUT

Know the audit gap. Know your next step.

GOVERNANCE REALITY · APRIL 2026

Cowork activity is not yet captured in audit logs, the Compliance API, or data exports. For regulated workloads — finance, healthcare, legal, investigations, wait, or use Cowork on AWS Bedrock.

01

Scope each user's connectors to what they actually need.

02

Review connector permissions quarterly.

03

Restrict which plugins users can install.

NEXT STEP

Pick one playbook. Run it Monday.

The weekly digest is the easiest first win. Three sources, one schedule, one Notion page. Get one finished output and the rest gets easy.

WANT HANDS-ON HELP?

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